

Chapter 193 - Part 2

Extra 15-2

Chen Mian's identity when she came here was that of an orphan, no longer having an Alpha's physique, just a very ordinary girl.

Her first twenty-some years were the kind of existence that would be submerged if placed in a crowd.

Chen Mian didn't want to do anything grand, and was even tired of being a painter or artist.

Having everything placed in display windows to be admired was a sad thing.

And Chen Mian hadn't yet decided what career to pursue, so she hovered around Qi Jiao.

Countless times, watching Qi Jiao working seriously from the side, she would silently space out.

Her thoughts drifting beyond the ninth heaven.

But even beyond the ninth heaven, it was still Qi Jiao.

This kind of day continued for a week.

In this week, Chen Mian had already thought of her career—she planned to become an art teacher at a nearby school.

Chen Mian used to really dislike the teaching profession, always feeling they were people seeking fame and reputation.

When in school, there was even a teacher who had talked about Qi Jiao in class, saying she was a delicate flower who never participated in school activities.

From that time on, Chen Mian didn't like the teaching profession.

Especially when Qi Jiao jumped from the school rooftop back then, those days at school became Chen Mian's nightmare countless times.

Chen Mian hated school for a period of time.

But recently she would occasionally see Qi Jiao sitting at the flower shop entrance in the evening, watching middle school students after school, watching them cross the pedestrian crossing, laughing and playing in groups of three or five.

Qi Jiao said: "Seeing middle school students makes one feel so energetic."

So Chen Mian decided to become a teacher.

Just that Chen Mian didn't expect that teachers at this school had to take exams—

So she learned a new term: bianzhi¹.

Chen Mian looked up a lot of information before understanding what this meant.

Qi Jiao asked in surprise: "You didn't know before?"

Chen Mian: "..."

Chen Mian silently studied educational knowledge.

Qi Jiao's flower shop business wasn't very good, but it wasn't bad either.

Every day people would come to buy flowers.

Sometimes it was affectionate couples, sometimes single girls returning home late from work, sometimes white-haired elderly people. Qi Jiao would recommend suitable flowers to all of them.

Chen Mian asked Qi Jiao: "Why did you want to open a flower shop?"

Qi Jiao thought for a moment and answered: "Flowers can bring people hope."

"I heard a saying before." Qi Jiao said: "The existence of flowers isn't to become scenery, but to make people's hearts peaceful."

Chen Mian: "..."

Chen Mian stood in front of the table, smiling as she asked: "Who said that?"

Qi Jiao shook her head: "I can't remember."

Qi Jiao also said: "I searched online and couldn't find where it came from either."

Chen Mian smiled softly, saying nothing.

Qi Jiao couldn't find the source because these were words Chen Mian had once said to her.

Unexpectedly, she still remembered.

After staying at the flower shop for a long time, Chen Mian gradually could also wrap beautiful flower arrangements.

But Qi Jiao said wrapping flowers wasn't suitable for her.

So Chen Mian asked: "Then what suits me?"

"How would I know?" Qi Jiao said, then paused and tentatively suggested: "Why don't you paint?"

So Chen Mian painted all the wrapped flowers in Qi Jiao's shop.

Almost no repeated color schemes each day.

Qi Jiao could always think of unique combinations.

And Chen Mian really liked painting on the street.

Moving a stool, setting up an easel, calmly starting to paint.

Chen Mian painted in oils, and occasionally people would come to watch.

Chen Mian's looks weren't outstanding, her features all quite ordinary, but combined together she had a unique temperament.

That kind of temperament unique to artists—"you can't stand me but you can't get rid of me either"—everyone thought she was aloof.

Qi Jiao would occasionally glance up inadvertently while wrapping flowers in the shop, and seeing Chen Mian's quiet silhouette would smile softly, that kind of unconsciously gentle smile.

One day a customer reminded her, and only then did she realize she'd been staring too intently.

But somehow, she just really liked Chen Mian.

The feeling that she was naturally meant to like her.

She also felt they must have known each other for a long time.

Even though aside from liking the same song "Lone Bird Syndrome," they liked many other things differently.

But Qi Jiao just felt it was right.

No one else could make her smile just by seeing them.

Only Chen Mian.

Chen Mian gradually became a beautiful sight at the entrance.

Naturally, this news couldn't be hidden from Qi Jiao's family.

During dinner that evening, her sister opened with: "Is someone pursuing you?"

Qi Jiao froze, her eyes darting around. Her brother immediately patted her head: "You're not the type to lie, tell the truth."

Qi Jiao put down her bowl with a red face, stammering: "There... there isn't."

Her sister and brother said in unison: "So it's true then."

Qi Jiao: "..."

Qi Jiao immediately fled.

While her parents gossiped: "Someone's pursuing Jiaojiao? How old? Handsome? What do they do for work?"

Her sister and brother exchanged glances, and finally her sister stated the harsh truth: "Don't know how old, it's a girl, looks okay I guess, not as pretty as Jiaojiao."

"A girl?" Her parents exclaimed in unison.

Finally her mother waved her hand, "Whatever, as long as Jiaojiao likes them, who cares if it's a boy or girl."

Meanwhile, Qi Jiao, who had fled back to her bedroom and was leaning against the door, suddenly felt her phone vibrate.

She opened it—it was a message from Chen Mian: [Want to watch the sunrise tomorrow morning?]

Footnotes:

¹ Bianzhi (编制) - A permanent position/establishment in the Chinese public sector system, particularly valued for job security and benefits in fields like education